

Answer Key TOEFL iBT Reading Model Test Placement Test

READING 1 “Beowulf”

1. **C** “...*Beowulf* was written by an anonymous [author unknown] Englishman in Old English.” Choice A is not correct because it is one of four surviving manuscripts. Choice B is not correct because scholars do not know if it is the sole surviving epic from about A.D. 1000.
2. **B** “...the original manuscript was probably lost during the ninth century..., in which the Danes destroyed the Anglo-Saxon monasteries and their great libraries.” Choice A is true but it is not the reason that scholars believe the original manuscript was lost. Choice C is not correct because the Danes were invaders, not poets. Choice D is not correct because the location of the discovery is not mentioned, although the author may have been a monk.
3. **A** Because the word “apparently” means “appearing to be so,” the author is expressing doubt about the information that follows, “.....[the *Beowulf* poet] was a Christian.” Choice B is not correct because the word “obviously” would be used. Choice C is not correct because the phrases “for example” or “for instance” would signal an example. Choice D is not correct because evidence would not be presented as “appearing to be so.”
4. **A** “Iron was accessible everywhere in Scandinavia, usually in the form of ‘bog iron’ found in the layers of peat in peat bogs.” Choice B is not correct because the author had already stated that the best swords had iron or iron-edged blades. Choice C is not correct because the Celts taught the Northmen how to use the materials, but they did not provide the bog iron. Choice D is not correct because the bog iron does not relate to the date, although 500 B.C. is mentioned as the time when the Northmen learned how to forge iron.
5. **B** In this passage, *rare* is a synonym for “unique”. Context comes from the reference to the “sole surviving epic” in the beginning of the same sentence.
6. **B** In this passage, *demonstrates* is a synonym for “exhibits.”
7. **C** In this passage, *refuse* is a synonym for “reject.” Context comes from the contrast with “accept” in the previous sentence.
8. **A** *Society in Anglo-Saxon England* paraphrases “Anglo-Saxon society.” *both advanced* paraphrases “neither primitive,” and *cultured* paraphrases “nor uncultured”. Two negatives [*nor* and *–un*] produce an affirmative meaning.
9. **B** Addition is a transitional device that connects the insert sentence with the previous sentence. *Moreover* signals that additional, related information will follow.”they scholars] disagree” refers to “Scholars do not know” in the previous sentence.
10. **E, D, F** summarize the passage. Choice A is true, but it is a minor point that establishes the time period for the poem and refers to major point D. Choice B is true, but it is a detail that refers to major point E and explains why there may be only one manuscript. Choice C is not clear from the information in the passage.

Reading 2 “Thermoregulation”

11. **A** “The most basic mechanism [for maintenance of warm body temperature] is the metabolic rate.” Choices B, C, and D are all ways to maintain body temperature, but they are not the most fundamental adaptation.
12. **D** Choice A is mentioned in paragraph 6, sentence 7. Choice B is mentioned in paragraph 6, sentence 8. Choice C is mentioned in paragraph 6, sentences 3 and 4.
13. **D** “In some mammals, certain hormones can cause mitochondria to increase their metabolic activity and produce heat instead of ATP. **This nonshivering thermogenesis (NST).....**” Choice A is not correct because thermogenesis is the activity that generates heat, not the heat loss. Choice B is not correct because brown fat is one example of a more generalized process. Choice C is not correct because thermogenesis is a response to the environment to maintain the health of the animal, not a process that maintains the environment.
14. **A** “.....capable of astonishing feats of thermoregulation. For example, small birds called chickadees...hold body temperature nearly constant.” Choice B is not correct because the food supply supports thermoregulation, which is the main point of the example. Choice C is not correct because chickadees are capable of astonishing feats of thermoregulation. Choice D is not correct because the reason for heat production in animals is explained before the example of the chickadee.
15. **D** In this passage, *smallest* is a synonym for “minimal.”
16. **D** In this passage, *control* is a synonym for “regulate”. Context comes from the reference to “temperature differences” at the end of the same sentence.
17. **B** In this passage *improve* is a synonym for “enhance”. Context comes from the reference to “promote” in the previous sentence.
18. **B** A passive grammatical structure in the passage is paraphrased by an active grammatical structure in the answer choice.
19. **A** Reference is a transitional device that connects the insert sentence with the previous sentence”..... a layer of fur or feathers” and “how much still air the layer [of fur or feathers] traps” in the insert sentence refers to “.....fur or feathers” and “a thicker layer [of fur or feathers] traps” in the previous sentence.
20. **E, C, F** summarize the passage. Choice A is a minor point that supports major point C. Choice B is true but it is not mentioned in the passage. Choice D is a minor point that supports major point F.